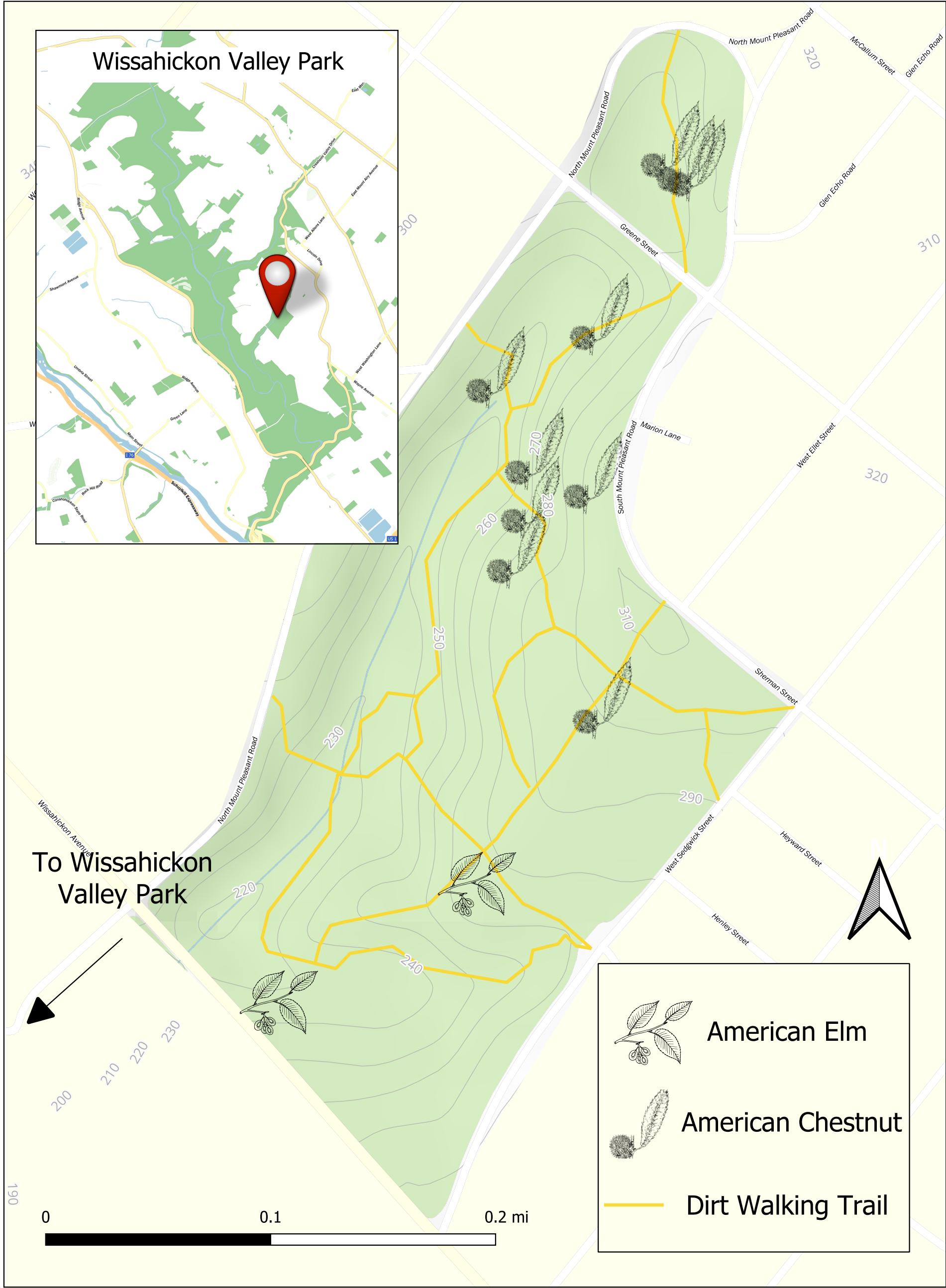


A Walk Through Time in Carpenters Woods



A Quiet Demise

The American Elm or *Ulmus americanus*, was once one of the most popular street trees within the United States. Beginning in the 1920's this species was devastated by the invasive pathogen, Dutch Elm Disease. This once common tree, host to many species of lepidoptera such as the Eastern Comma, Question Mark and Morning Cloak, is now relegated to quieter corners where individuals have withstood the disease.

The American Chestnut or *Castanea dentata*, was once a common site within the Appalachian Mountains. These trees provided an important food source for many mammals, including people, and is the sole host for the Greater Chestnut Weevil. Beginning in 1904, their population was decimated due to the Chestnut Blight.

Although a few individuals of both these species still remain, they are both functionally extinct. This means that they exist at a density that is too low to fulfill their ecological roles within their respective communities.

Finding Hope

The individuals mapped here, while few, allow us to maintain these species in our living memory while we continue to work towards their preservation.

Ongoing Preservation Efforts:

